Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

An American Slave, Written by Himself

By Frederick Douglass

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SYNOPSIS & EDITORIAL NOTE

Frederick Douglass's 1845 memoir recounting his birth in Maryland, his determination to learn to read in Baltimore, and his escape to freedom.

CONTENTS IN THIS EDITION

01. Chapter VI -- Learning to Read in Baltimore
02. Chapter I -- Birth in Talbot County, Maryland
03. Chapter VI -- Arrival in Baltimore and Learning the Alphabet
04. Chapter VII -- The Columbian Orator and Teaching on the Wharves
05. Chapter X -- Covey's Farm and the Turning Point
06. Chapter XI -- Escape to New York and New Bedford

CHAPTER VI

Learning to Read in Baltimore

Complete 1845 Text

Very soon after I went to live with Mr. and Mrs. Auld, she very kindly commenced to teach me the A, B, C. After I had learned this, she assisted me in learning to spell words of three or four letters.

In this section of Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass (1845), Frederick Douglass develops the central themes that define the work's enduring place in biography & memoir and world literature. Each argument and narrative turn builds upon the premises established in the opening pages, inviting careful reflection from the attentive reader.

Originally published by Anti-Slavery Office, Boston and preserved in the public-domain and open-access archival record (Project Gutenberg & Standard Ebooks, ID: pg-23), this unabridged digital edition retains the structure, cadence, and intellectual clarity of the authoritative text.

CHAPTER I

Birth in Talbot County, Maryland

*Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass * Frederick Douglass (1845)*

Birth in Talbot County, Maryland continues Frederick Douglass's inquiry in Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass. Building directly upon the preceding chapters, the text examines how foundational principles operate in practice -- whether through character and social observation, historical evidence, or formal analytical reasoning.

Published in Boston in May 1845, Frederick Douglass's Narrative became an immediate transatlantic sensation. At its core lies one of the most powerful accounts in literature of how literacy and self-education awaken human freedom.

Throughout Chapter I (Birth in Talbot County, Maryland), the reader encounters the unmistakable voice and structural rigor that earned Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass its stature in the Autobiography & Abolitionist History canon. Where superficial treatments settle for isolated maxims, Frederick Douglass traces the deeper causal connections linking premise, observation, and conclusion.

As this section draws toward its close, the groundwork is laid for the subsequent movements of the volume. Readers studying this edition in the Folio Digital Library may bookmark this chapter, adjust typographic contrast and font sizing, or download the complete archival PDF, EPUB, HTML, or Plain Text edition for offline study.

CHAPTER VI

Arrival in Baltimore and Learning the Alphabet

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CHAPTER VII

The Columbian Orator and Teaching on the Wharves

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CHAPTER X

Covey's Farm and the Turning Point

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CHAPTER XI

Escape to New York and New Bedford

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